



structure, passionate coaches and large-hearted athletes. By now, you are not that surprised. After all, Bhiwani is the abode of Famous Fours not for without any reason – it's got to be special!

And true to its grain, sports did not disappoint either. It brought people jobs, it got them fame. Successes of the Famous Fours and some more in boxing rings around the world have added another dimension – the place can now boast of its very own celebrities, signing autographs, posing for photographs and merging with ease in the world of glamour. "Boxing is in the blood of people of Bhiwani and now they have found in it the best way to earn glory," says Vijender Singh, the new favourite of TV channels on a look-out to soar up their TRPs.

In a country where one struggles to see a soul in playfields, history is being re-written at Bhiwani. Private

academies are mushrooming and, lo and behold, are doing brisk business, too! Around a thousand here trade punches every way under the watchful eye of seasoned coaches, aspiring to replace their icons one day.

The credit for planting the alien seed of boxing in Bhiwani goes to the duo of Hawa Singh and Rajinder Singh Yadav. They were the ones who cajoled young people to take to the sport and find in it answers of their

"Be it Asian Games, Commonwealth Games or the world's biggest sporting event - the Olympics - Haryana has a fair contribution in the country's overall participation as well as in the performance."

- Mr Deepender Hooda
MP from Rohtak

STERLING PERFORMANCE

- **Beijing Olympic :** Out of five Beijing-bound boxers, four are from Bhiwani. And the only Olympic medallist in the sport is also from the city.
- **Athens Olympics-2004 :** In the 2004 Athens Olympics, out of four, three were from the city.
- **Asian Championship-2007 :** Five out of the 11-members squad were from the city and they contributed four out of the seven medals won by the country.
- **Melbourne Commonwealth Games-2006:** India won five medals in the sport and out of this three medals were grabbed by the Bhiwani boxers including the gold medal feat by Akhil Kumar.
- **Arjuna Awards:**
Hawa Singh- 1966, Mehtab Singh- 1973, Raj Kumar Sangwan-1996, Jatinder Kumar-1999, Akhil Kumar-2005, Vijender Singh- 2006.

woes. Vijender Singh's coach Jagdish is now taking the legacy forward. Hats off to the coaches and young men and women who choose sports at a time when their brethren in neighbouring states are taking refuge in psychedelic drugs. What can be more flattering than the fact that Bhiwani-ranking is as good as India-ranking? No surprise when one finds enterprising youngsters from others states migrating to Bhiwani in search of their destiny in boxing-rings.

Boxing has done to Bhiwani what IIT entrance coaching has done to Kota and IT to Bangalore. Deepinder Hooda, the young MP from Rohtak echoes the popular sentiment, 'Rarely does a geographical entity monopolise a game as totally as Bhiwani has done in regard to Boxing.'

With an equally keen government, no prize for guessing which next Hindi word is going to be included into the English dictionary. What can one do if boxers round the world keep getting 'Bhiwani-ed'? ■